Payments API Error Code Catalogue

Document control	
Catalogue version	2026.3
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Applies to	Kestrel Payments API v2, all API versions from 2025-11-01
Public version	The merchant-facing subset is published in the developer docs. This catalogue adds internal notes.

How errors are returned

Every failed request returns an HTTP status and a JSON body with a `KP-` code:

```
{
  "error": {
    "code": "KP-4031",
    "message": "Strong Customer Authentication required",
    "decline_code": "sca_required",
    "request_id": "req_8Qm2Tx4Lw9"
  }
}
```

Codes are four digits after `KP-`. The first digit is the family:

Family	Range	Covers
1	KP-1000 to KP-1999	Authentication, permissions and rate limits
2	KP-2000 to KP-2999	Request validation
3	KP-3000 to KP-3999	Merchant account state
4	KP-4000 to KP-4999	Card payments and declines (Kestrel Checkout)
5	KP-5000 to KP-5999	Payouts (Kestrel Payouts)
9	KP-9000 to KP-9999	Kestrel or upstream system faults

Do not confuse `KP-` error codes with Kestrel Payouts SKUs such as KP-BULK-500. SKUs always contain letters after the prefix.

Always quote the `request_id` when you raise a ticket with Payments Engineering.

Family 1: authentication and limits

Code	HTTP	Meaning	Retry	What the merchant should do
KP-1001	401	API key missing or not recognised	No	Send a live key (`kp_live_`) in live mode or a test key (`kp_test_`) in the sandbox, in the `Authorization` header.
KP-1002	401	API key revoked	No	Create a new key in Dashboard, Developers, API keys. Old keys are revoked 7 days after a rotation.
KP-1003	403	Key lacks the scope for this endpoint	No	Add the scope (for example `payouts:write`) to the key, or use a key that has it.
KP-1004	403	Request came from an IP address not on the allowlist	No	Add the address in Dashboard, Developers, IP allowlist. Changes take up to 5 minutes.
KP-1009	429	Rate limit exceeded	Yes, after `Retry-After`	Back off and retry. Default limits are 100 requests a second per merchant, and 25 a second for Payouts endpoints.

Family 2: validation

Code	HTTP	Meaning	Retry	What the merchant should do
KP-2001	400	Body is not valid JSON	No	Fix the request body.
KP-2004	422	Required field missing	No	`error.field` names the missing field.
KP-2007	422	Currency not enabled for this merchant	No	GBP and EUR are enabled by default. Other currencies need a support request.
KP-2009	422	Amount out of range	No	Amounts are in minor units. The minimum card payment is 30p or €0.30.
KP-2012	409	Idempotency key reused with a different body	No	Reuse a key only to retry the identical request. Use a new key for a new payment.
KP-2015	422	Webhook URL is not HTTPS or did not answer	No	Use an HTTPS URL that returns 200 within 10 seconds.

Family 3: account state

Code	HTTP	Meaning	Retry	What the merchant should do
KP-3002	403	Merchant account restricted	No	Contact Kestrel support. See the internal note below.
KP-3005	403	Product not enabled on the account	No	Apply for the product in the Dashboard, for example Payouts.
KP-3010	409	Settlement bank account not verified	No	Verify the account in Dashboard, Settings, Bank accounts. Settlement is held until it is verified.
KP-3014	402	Monthly processing limit reached	No	The limit is shown in Dashboard, Settings, Limits. Ask the account manager for a review.

Internal note on KP-3002. A restriction usually means a KYB or financial crime review is open. Support and Sales must never tell the merchant why the account is restricted, or that a review exists, because that can be tipping off. Route every KP-3002 question to Compliance (Sofia Lindqvist) as described in the Customer Success Escalation Guide.

Family 4: card payments

Code	HTTP	Meaning	Retry	What the merchant should do
KP-4001	402	Declined by the issuer, no reason given	Once, after the customer checks their details	Ask the customer to use another card or call their bank. Do not retry the same card more than once in 24 hours.
KP-4005	402	Insufficient funds	No	Ask for another payment method.
KP-4012	402	Card expired	No	Ask for an up-to-date card.
KP-4019	402	Incorrect CVC	Yes, with corrected details	Ask the customer to re-enter the security code. Repeated failures on one card lead to KP-4040.
KP-4030	402	Deprecated. Was "3-D Secure required or failed"	n/a	Replaced in March 2026 by KP-4031, KP-4032 and KP-4033. Integrations pinned to API version 2025-11-01 still receive it.
KP-4031	402	Soft decline: the issuer requires Strong Customer Authentication	Yes, with 3-D Secure only	Retry the same payment with 3-D Secure by setting `authentication.mode` to `challenge`, and send the customer through their bank's check (app approval or a one-time passcode). A retry without 3-D Secure will be declined again.
KP-4032	402	3-D Secure authentication failed	No	The customer failed their bank's check. Ask them to use another card or contact their bank.
KP-4033	402	3-D Secure abandoned or timed out	Yes, if the customer asks	The customer did not finish the check within 10 minutes. Offer to start the payment again.
KP-4040	402	Blocked by Kestrel Shield fraud screening	No	Do not retry. Tell the customer the payment could not be completed and offer another method. Do not say it was flagged as fraud. The merchant can ask support to review the block.
KP-4041	402	Issuer declined for suspected fraud	No	Ask the customer to contact their bank.
KP-4050	402	Amount over the single transaction limit	No	Limits are £5,000 on Checkout Standard and £20,000 on Checkout Pro. The account manager can request a higher limit.
KP-4062	402	Card brand not enabled	No	American Express is off by default. Enable it in Dashboard, Settings, Payment methods.

Internal note on KP-4031. Hosted Checkout pages and the mobile SDKs retry with 3-D Secure automatically, so only merchants on a direct API integration see KP-4031. If one merchant shows more than 5% of attempts ending in KP-4031 over a day, their integration is probably not sending the `authentication` object. Raise it with the Sales Engineer for the account (Ravi Shah for UK direct integrations).

Internal note on KP-4040. Support can see which Kestrel Shield rule fired, but must not share rule names or thresholds with merchants or with Sales. The rules are restricted to Payments Engineering and Security.

Family 5: payouts

Code	HTTP	Meaning	Retry	What the merchant should do
KP-5001	422	Beneficiary bank details invalid	No	The sort code and account number failed the modulus check, or the IBAN is malformed. Check the details with the payee.
KP-5003	422	Confirmation of Payee: no match	No	The name does not match the account. Check with the payee before trying again.
KP-5004	202	Confirmation of Payee: close match	Not needed	The payout is held. Confirm it in the Dashboard or with `POST /v2/payouts/{id}/confirm` within 24 hours, or it is cancelled.
KP-5010	402	Balance too low to fund the payout	Yes, after funding	Top up the Kestrel Accounts balance, then resubmit.
KP-5017	409	Duplicate batch reference	No	A batch with this `batch_reference` was submitted in the last 30 days. Check the first batch before resubmitting, so nobody is paid twice.
KP-5021	503	Payment scheme unavailable	No, Kestrel retries	Faster Payments or SEPA Instant is down. Kestrel retries for up to 4 hours, then sends a `payout.failed` webhook.
KP-5030	422	SEPA cut-off missed	No, automatic	Standard SEPA payouts received after 14:30 CET go out on the next business day.

Family 9: system faults

Code	HTTP	Meaning	Retry	What the merchant should do
KP-9001	500	Internal error	Yes, same idempotency key	Retry with exponential backoff (1, 2, 4, 8 and 16 seconds), then contact support.
KP-9003	503	Service temporarily unavailable	Yes, after `Retry-After`	Check status.kestrelpay.example and retry after the `Retry-After` interval.
KP-9007	504	Timed out waiting for the card acquirer; outcome unknown	Not as a new payment	Do not create a new payment. Wait 60 seconds, then call `GET /v2/payments/{id}`. If the status is still `pending`, the final status arrives by webhook within 15 minutes. Only ever retry with the same idempotency key: a retry with a new key can charge the card twice.

Change note, August 2026. The KP-9007 guidance was rewritten after incident INC-2026-0817 on 17 August 2026, when merchants retrying KP-9007 with new idempotency keys created duplicate authorisations. Customer Success sent the new wording to every Checkout merchant on a direct integration on 21 August.

Most frequent declines

Share of all declined card payments, July 2026:

Code	Share of declines
KP-4001	31%
KP-4005	22%
KP-4031	14%
KP-4012	9%
KP-4019	8%
KP-4040	4%
All other codes	12%

Changing this catalogue

New codes are added by a pull request to the `merchant-api` repository that updates `errors.yaml`, with a review from Payments Product. Never reuse a retired code. Codes are deprecated for at least 6 months before removal, and the deprecation is announced in the developer changelog.